



English AI
Local Coach

ENGLISH AI · THEORY LESSON

Restaurant & Ordering Food

Vocabulary, useful phrases, grammar, writing and conversation practice

Level A2-B1 · 45-60 min · Lesson 03

LESSON GOAL

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to book a table, understand a menu, order a complete meal, ask about ingredients, solve common restaurant problems, and write a short restaurant review.

Learn the vocabulary first, then practise the functional phrases and writing tasks. Finish by opening the Conversation Lab and acting out the restaurant situations.

Study tip

Learn restaurant English in chunks: “book a table”, “order a main course”, “ask for the bill”, “pay by card”. Complete expressions are much easier to retrieve during a real conversation.

[START HERE](#)

Lesson map

A simple sequence: understand the restaurant language, build accurate requests, then use everything in a realistic conversation.

01

LEARN

Vocabulary + useful phrases

02

BUILD

Grammar + writing

03

SPEAK

Dialogue + role-play

Warm-up

1. What is your favourite type of restaurant?
2. What food do you usually order when you eat out?
3. Do you prefer trying new dishes or ordering something familiar?
4. Have you ever had a problem in a restaurant? What happened?

Before you continue

Answer the four questions in English with short sentences. You will reuse these ideas in the writing and speaking sections later.

VOCABULARY 01

Core restaurant vocabulary

These words cover the most common parts of eating out, from booking a table to paying the bill.

WORD / PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE
reservation	reserva	I have a reservation for two people.
table for two	mesa para duas pessoas	Could we have a table for two?
menu	cardápio	Could I see the menu, please?
starter / appetizer	entrada	We would like one starter to share.
main course	prato principal	What do you recommend for the main course?
side dish	acompanhamento	Does the steak come with a side dish?
dessert	sobremesa	I think I will have dessert.
drink	bebida	Would you like something to drink?
dish	prato / preparação	This is the most popular dish here.
ingredient	ingrediente	Does this dish contain nuts?
waiter / waitress	garçom / garçonete	The waiter brought our drinks.
order	pedido / pedir	Are you ready to order?
bill / check	conta	Could we have the bill, please?
tip	gorjeta	Is the tip included?
receipt	recibo	Could I have the receipt?
reservation name	nome da reserva	The reservation is under Cunali.

VOCABULARY 02

Natural combinations

Fluent speakers often retrieve groups of words together. Memorise these combinations as complete units.

- book a table** - reserve a table before arriving
- make a reservation** - arrange a table in advance
- look at the menu** - read the available food and drinks
- order a starter** - choose an appetizer
- have the steak** - choose the steak as your meal
- come with fries** - be served together with fries
- ask about ingredients** - check what a dish contains
- recommend a dish** - suggest something to eat
- send a dish back** - return food because there is a problem
- ask for the bill** - request the final amount to pay
- split the bill** - divide the total between people
- pay by card** - use a debit or credit card
- leave a tip** - give extra money for service
- eat out** - eat at a restaurant instead of at home

Notice

In English, we usually say “have the chicken” or “I will have the pasta” when ordering. It is natural and polite in restaurants.

Quick practice

Complete: _____ a table for four.

Complete: ask _____ the bill.

Complete: pay _____ card.

Write one sentence with “split the bill”.

USEFUL LANGUAGE

Phrases you can actually use

Organise the phrases by moment: arriving, ordering, asking questions, solving a problem, and paying.

ARRIVING

- I have a reservation for two under the name Cunali.
- Do you have a table available?
- Could we sit by the window?

ORDERING

- Could I have the chicken, please?
- I would like the pasta as my main course.
- We are ready to order.
- Could we have some water for the table?

ASKING ABOUT FOOD

- What do you recommend?
- What comes with this dish?
- Is this dish spicy?
- Does this contain nuts / dairy / gluten?
- Could I have this without onions?

PROBLEMS

- Excuse me, I think this is not what I ordered.
- My food is cold. Could you heat it up, please?
- We are still waiting for our drinks.
- Could you check our order, please?

PAYING

- Could we have the bill, please?
- Can we split the bill?
- Is service included?
- Can I pay by card?

GRAMMAR

Polite ordering: I would like / Could I / Can I

The goal is not complicated grammar. The goal is choosing forms that sound natural and polite in a restaurant.

PATTERN	EXAMPLE	USE
I would like + noun	I would like the grilled salmon, please.	polite, clear choice
I'd like to + verb	I'd like to order now, please.	polite intention
Could I have + noun?	Could I have some water, please?	very common polite request
Can I have + noun?	Can I have the burger, please?	natural and slightly more casual
Could you + verb?	Could you bring us another menu, please?	ask someone to do something

Natural English

“I want the steak” is grammatically correct, but “I would like the steak” or “I will have the steak” sounds more natural and polite in a restaurant.

Mini practice

Rewrite politely: Give me the menu. → _____

Complete: Could I _____ the chicken, please?

Complete: I would _____ the soup as a starter.

Write a polite request for another glass of water.

MODEL DIALOGUE

Ordering dinner

Read once for meaning, then read again and notice the reusable patterns for recommendations, ingredients, ordering, and payment.

WAITER Good evening. Are you ready to order?

CUSTOMER Almost. What do you recommend for the main course?

WAITER The grilled salmon and the steak are both very popular.

CUSTOMER Does the salmon come with any side dishes?

WAITER Yes. It comes with roasted vegetables and rice.

CUSTOMER Great. I would like the salmon, please. Could I have it without onions?

WAITER Of course. Would you like anything to drink?

CUSTOMER Yes, could I have sparkling water, please?

WAITER Certainly. Would you like a starter?

CUSTOMER No, thank you. That is all for now.

WAITER Perfect. I will bring your drink first.

CUSTOMER Thank you.

CUSTOMER Excuse me, could we have the bill, please?

WAITER Absolutely. Would you like to pay together or separately?

CUSTOMER Separately, please. I will pay by card.

Language to steal

“What do you recommend?”, “Does it come with...?”, “Could I have it without...?”, and “Could we have the bill?” are highly reusable restaurant patterns.

Comprehension

1. Which main course does the customer choose?
2. What side dishes come with it?
3. What change does the customer request?
4. How does the customer pay?

WRITING PRACTICE 01

Build accurate sentences

Translate the sentences into English using the vocabulary and structures from this lesson.

1. Eu tenho uma reserva para duas pessoas.
2. Nós estamos prontos para pedir.
3. O que você recomenda como prato principal?
4. Este prato vem com batatas fritas?
5. Eu gostaria do frango grelhado, por favor.
6. Eu poderia pedir isso sem cebola?
7. Este prato contém castanhas?
8. Desculpe, este não é o prato que eu pedi.
9. Nós poderíamos pedir a conta, por favor?
10. Podemos dividir a conta?
11. O serviço está incluído?
12. Eu posso pagar com cartão?

WRITING PRACTICE 02

Write a short restaurant review

Combine the vocabulary into a short, realistic text. Imagine you are reviewing a restaurant after dinner.

Task: Write 80-120 words about a restaurant. Mention the atmosphere, service, what you ordered, what you liked, and one problem or suggestion.

Try to include at least 6 of these:

- reservation
- starter
- main course
- side dish
- recommend
- service
- waiter / waitress
- bill
- pay by card
- dessert

Useful structure

I went to... / We had a reservation... / I ordered... / The food was... / The service was... / However... / Overall, I would...

Self-check before you finish

- ☐ Did I use complete sentences?
- ☐ Did I include at least 6 target words?
- ☐ Did I describe both food and service?
- ☐ Did I connect ideas with but / however / because / overall?

CONVERSATION PRACTICE

Role-plays for the AI coach

Open the Conversation Lab and ask the AI to stay in character. Complete each situation before asking for corrections.

Role-play 1 · Booking and arriving

Call a restaurant and book a table for four at 8 p.m. Then arrive, give the reservation name, and ask for a table by the window.

Role-play 2 · Ordering dinner

Ask for a recommendation, ask what comes with one dish, check whether it contains nuts, order a main course, and request a drink.

Role-play 3 · Solving a problem

Your food is cold and one side dish is missing. Explain both problems politely, then ask for the bill and say you want to pay by card.

Conversation questions

- What makes a restaurant worth returning to?
- Do you usually order a starter or dessert? Why?
- What food would you recommend to a visitor in Brazil?
- Would you complain if your food arrived cold?
- Do you prefer splitting the bill or paying together?

REVIEW

Mini test

Complete this without looking back. Check what is already automatic and what still needs another review.

1. Translate: cardápio = _____
2. Translate: prato principal = _____
3. Complete: I have a reservation _____ four people.
4. Complete: Could I _____ the steak, please?
5. Complete: What does this dish come _____?
6. Choose: “Could I / I want” have some water, please?
7. Rewrite politely: “Bring me the bill.”
8. Complete: Can we _____ the bill?
9. What is the difference between a starter and a main course?
10. Write one sentence with “recommend”.
11. Write one sentence with “ingredients”.
12. Translate: “Este prato contém castanhas?”
13. Translate: “Eu gostaria do salmão.”
14. Write a question about paying by card.
15. Write a polite sentence to report that your food is cold.

ANSWER KEY

Check and learn from your mistakes

Some answers can vary. The examples below show natural versions using the language taught in the lesson.

Quick practice - Vocabulary

- book / make
- for
- by
- Example: We split the bill after dinner.

Grammar mini practice

- Could you bring me the menu, please?
- have
- like
- Example: Could I have another glass of water, please?

Writing practice 01 - Suggested answers

1. I have a reservation for two people.
2. We are ready to order.
3. What do you recommend for the main course?
4. Does this dish come with fries?
5. I would like the grilled chicken, please.
6. Could I have this without onions?
7. Does this dish contain nuts?
8. Excuse me, this is not what I ordered.
9. Could we have the bill, please?
10. Can we split the bill?
11. Is service included?
12. Can I pay by card?

FINISH

Mini test answers + progress check

Use the score only as a guide. The real goal is to use the language naturally without translating every word in your head.

1. menu
2. main course
3. for
4. have
5. with
6. Could I
7. Could you bring us the bill, please?
8. split
9. A starter is eaten before the main course; the main course is the principal dish.
- 10-11. Answers vary.
12. Does this dish contain nuts?
13. I would like the salmon. / I will have the salmon.
14. Example: Can I pay by card?
15. Example: Excuse me, my food is cold. Could you heat it up, please?

READY FOR CONVERSATION?

If you can do these four things, move to the Conversation Lab.

- ✓ Book a table and confirm a reservation.
- ✓ Order food and ask about ingredients.
- ✓ Report a restaurant problem politely.
- ✓ Write an 80-120 word restaurant review.

Next lesson suggestion: Shopping & Clothing